



If you're a complete noob when it comes to Google+ and have absolutely no clue about what we're talking here, read our UI Walkthrough on [thinkdigit.com](http://bit.ly/digitgplus) (<http://bit.ly/digitgplus>). This back-to-the-basics article will help you get around Google+ in no time.

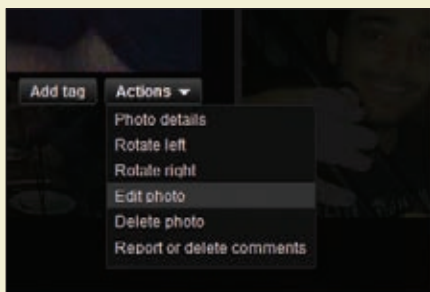
Android device on to Google+. Yes, it won't share it unless you choose to, but our paranoid selves felt it an invasion of privacy. So here's how you disable it: On your Android device go to the Google+ app. After log-in hit the options key. Tap Settings and uncheck Instant Upload. This will stop it entirely. If you want to further customise when to upload, Tap on Instant Upload settings.

Tweak your Sparks

The default interest areas covered in Sparks (left pane) are pretty lame. To add more interest areas, simply type your interest (say technology) in the search bar and click "Add interest". This will pin that interest to your sparks. The default sources are pretty good.

Edit photos before sharing

When you go to your photos find the little magnifying glass that appears at the bottom left corner of the thumbnail. Once you click on it the photo will fill up the screen and you'll see an "Actions" dropdown menu. Here you'll find the Edit Photo option. Google+ has six basic



Edit photo option

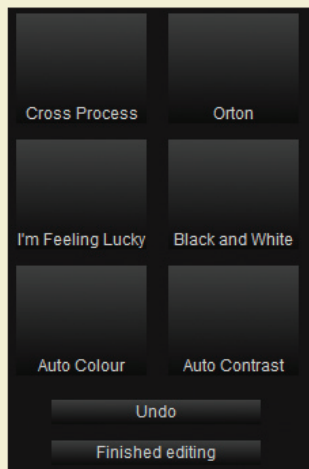


Image processing options in Google+

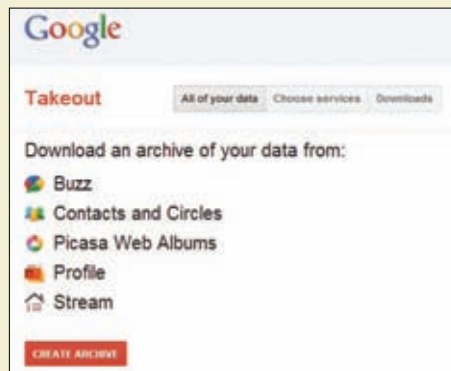
post processing options : Cross Process, Orton, I'm Feeling Lucky, Black and White, Auto Colour and Auto Contrast. The I'm Feeling Lucky option adjusts all levels as per its own algorithm. You also have the option of undoing any of the filters you've applied. Once done click "Finished editing".

Manage circles easily

No matter how much fun you try to make it with all the drag and drop effects and such, organising hundreds of people into circles can be quite painful. A trick to make this easier is to open a few circles in tabs. Not browser tabs but tabs in the Circles section. To do this simply click on a circle and find the "View circle in tab" link. Unfortunately Google+ only allows one circle to be opened in the tab at once.

Backup your Google+ data

Through Google's Takeout service you can take a backup of your data on Google+. Items that you can backup include Buzz posts, Contacts and Circles, Picasa Web Albums, Profile and all posts on your



Backup Google+ data using Google Takeout

stream. To start the backup process, click on the Settings button at the extreme top-right corner of the screen. It resembles a cog.

Click through to Google+ settings. On the left side panel, you'll see a menu item called Data Liberation.

Next, click on the Download your data button, choose

what you'd like to backup and click Create Archive. This will create a .zip archive that can be downloaded on to your PC.

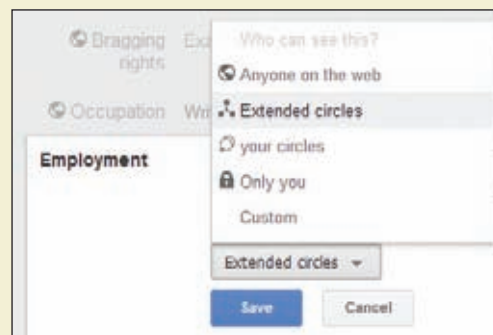
Incoming! Run for cover

You can check out what's happening on the periphery of your circles by clicking on the Incoming button in the left-

hand pane. Specifically these are posts shared by people who have you in their circles but who you haven't added yet. It might just be beneficial to keep an eye on this to make sure you've not missed anything interesting.

Privacy tips

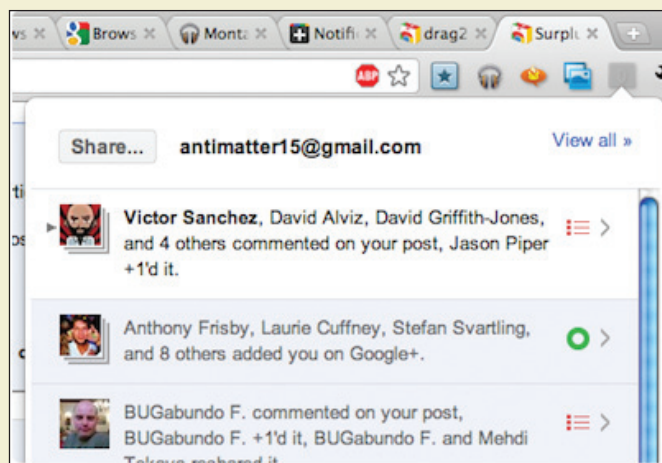
By default, Google+ is more open than we'd like. For example, on your profile, most of the sub-sec-



Profile visibility options

tions under the About tab, are set to "Visible to Everyone". You might've filled in some info back in the days when Google Buzz had a small spike in popularity. To change this, go into "Edit Profile more" and click on the little globe next to each section.

Get Google+ notifications in your



Surplus - the notification extension